We met on the climbing frames at Bosveldspruitjies, the nursery school across the road from Warmbaths Primary School, which we all attended; we were in the same rugby and cricket teams, constantly competing with each other, constantly chirping each other, and have remained pretty much as close and consistent ever since. Through all the twists and turns of our respective lives, we remain the same Skippy, Stof, Chris and AB.

The memories refuse to fade.

It is just another afternoon at primary school and four overactive boys are messing around in the playground, as ever throwing a rugby ball around. Disaster strikes when somebody kicks an over-ambitious up-and-under and the ball gets stuck in one of the thorn trees. Skip tries to shake the tree, but the ball doesn't move.

'Hey, AB,' says Stof. 'You've got a decent arm. Throw a brick at the ball. That will work.'

'Great idea,' I reply.

So we find half a brick. I take aim and manage to dislodge the ball with my first throw.

'Yeeeeeeeessssssssss,' I yell, arms outstretched in triumph.

But it's pride before a fall. The rugby ball falls neatly from the tree. Moments later, so does the half-brick and it lands squarely on my head, leaving me lying stunned on the ground with blood gushing from a serious gash.

Stof stays and does what he can to stop the bleeding, while Chris and Skip run to get help from the principal's office. I sit for the next hour or so with a bag of ice on my head. I survive.

It is just another Saturday, but far from just another rugby match for Warmbaths Primary School. This is the Schools' semifinal, and we are playing away to Pietersburg East Primary School. This is David vs Goliath. We are a tiny school with no rugby pedigree. They are revered giants in our world, and they play in orange.